

글쓰기

블랙아웃 시란 무엇인가? 정의, 예시 및 글쓰기 방법

2026년 4월 19일 샤미카 마르티네즈 작성

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주식

P ▶ 어쩌면 틱톡에서 유행하는 오디오에 맞춰 빠르게 움직이는 수십만 개의 영구 마커 보았거나, 서점에서 블랙아웃 시집을 집어 들었을 수도 있습니다. 또는 문자 그대로 기억을 잃었는데 어떻게 시 기사에 쓰게 되었는지 전혀 모르겠지만, 계속 함께해요! #BlackoutPoetry 시인이라고 생각하는 사람들만을 위한 것이 아닙니다. 오늘은 블랙아웃 시가 무엇인지, 역사적 뿌리, 다다이즘과의 연결, 그리고 왜 이것이 여러분의 작가의 슬럼프를 해소할 수 있는지 깊이 살펴보겠습니다.

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블랙아웃 시의 정의

먼저, 블랙아웃 시를 정의해 봅시다

블랙아웃 시는 시각 예술과 문학의 교차점에 존재합니다. **지우기** 또는 편집된 시라고도 불리는 블랙아웃 시는 발견된 예술(또는 발견된 시의 형태)의 전통에서 창작됩니다. 발견된(또는 기성품) 예술은 기존 재료를 새로운 예술 작품으로 변형시키는 것입니다.

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블랙아웃 시의 정의

블랙아웃 시란 무엇인가요?

블랙아웃 시는 작가가 기존 텍스트, 주로 책, 신문, 기사의 한 페이지를 가져와 대부분의 단어를 검게 가리거나 가리는 지우는 시의 한 종류입니다. 남은 단어들은 시를 구성하여 오래된 텍스트에 새로운 의미를 부여합니다.

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지우기 시의 여섯 가지 스타일:

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- 블랙아웃: 단어를 지우고 새로운 시를 만드는 것.
- 컴퓨터: 컴퓨터 소프트웨어를 사용해 줄을 추가하거나 제거하는 것.
- 오려내기: 종이에서 단어를 칼로 오려내는 것.
- 가려주기: 원문을 다른 재료로 가리는 것.
- 재타이핑: 원본 텍스트를 전통적인 시처럼 보이게 다시 타이핑하고, 원래 텍스트가 있던 자리에 공간을 남기는 것.
- 시각적: 콜라주, 드로잉, 회화 등 추가 시각적 요소를 포함합니다.

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What is Blackout Poetry Blackout Poetry Definition and Blackout Poetry Example

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BLACKOUT POETRY HISTORY

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The birth of the blackout poem

You may think blackout poetry is a more modern art, but the idea of creating new meaning from existing text isn't new. At least no more new than the idea of combining words and phrases. In fact, as long as print newspapers have existed, people have used redaction to create new bodies of work.

Poet Austin Kleon traced this back to the days of Benjamin Franklin. In one of the earliest known examples of blackout poetry art, Franklin's neighbor Caleb Whiteford published a broadsheet created from the very first print newspapers. Perhaps started as [comedy](#), his edited versions replaced serious news with jokes and puns. In another early

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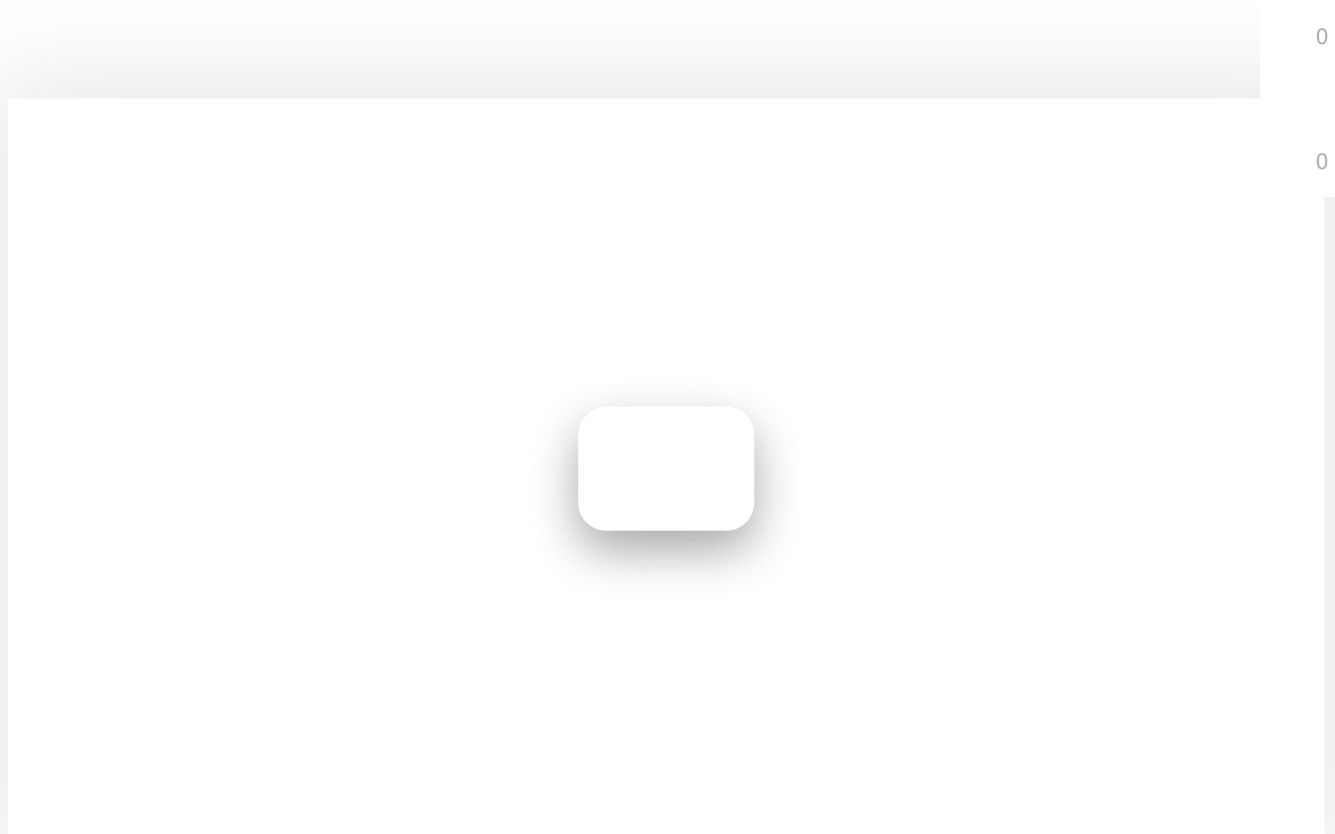


The modern resurgence of blackout poetry is often credited to writer Austin Kleon, whose 2010 book *Newspaper Blackout* helped popularize the form for a contemporary audience. Kleon's work demonstrated how everyday materials like newspapers could be transformed into striking, minimalist poems through redaction.

Around the same time, the broader literary movement of erasure poetry was gaining recognition, with poets like Tom Phillips (*A Humument*) and Ronald Johnson (*Radi Os*) using existing texts as raw material for entirely new works.

Presently, blackout poetry continues to evolve across both print and digital platforms. ⁰ _{주식} embraced by artists and social media creators as an accessible form of creative expression. ₀

The below video is a Ted Talk that covers the history of blackout poetry. Check out t ₀
compelling journey below. ₀



RELATED POSTS

- [What is Lyric Poetry — Definition and Examples →](#)
- [What is Repetition in Poetry — Examples & Functions →](#)
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BLACKOUT POETRY AND DADAISM

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Dada poets bring back the blackout

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The early 20th century saw the return of blackout poems with the [dada movement](#). Hugo Ball's "[Dada Manifesto](#)" named Dadaism "a new tendency in art" that rejected logic and reason in favor of chance. For Dada artists, "nonsense was the ultimate political tool to smash existing power structures and artistic norms," which might explain the popularity of absurd memes, video collage, and the rise of black out poet art today. That #aesthetic Tiktok video you love of seemingly random videos mixed with cartoons from the 1940's, set to a trap song? Dada.

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Tristan Tzara, one of Dada's founders, created poems by cutting out words on the page of a newspaper, putting them in a hat, and pulling them out at random to form verse. His "How to Make a Dadaist Poem," subverted the traditional confines of art and poetry, emphasizing spontaneity and chance.

Check out the compelling way Tzara would perform his art in the video below.

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BLACKOUT POETRY

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While many black out poems use black markers, blackout poems can be created by covering words with anything. For example, Erin Dorney's use of foliage.

The [Poetry Foundation](#) offers these excellent examples of erasure poetry: “[Freeland: An Erasure](#)” by Leigh Sugar; and [M. NourbeSe Philip's Zong!](#), “which uses court documents about the 18th-century slave ship that threw more than 120 enslaved Africans overboard in order to collect insurance money.”

Below are more examples that showcase the range of blackout and erasure poetry styles:

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Newspaper Blackout Poems

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As we've covered, the most common form of blackout poetry comes from newspaper Writers isolate phrases from headlines and articles to create poems that often comrn on current events. Because the source material is already rooted in reality, these poe can feel immediate, ironic, or even satirical depending on the word choices.

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Book Page Erasure Poetry

Using pages from novels or nonfiction books allows poets to work with richer, more descriptive language. These blackout poems are often more lyrical or narrative-driven, as the original text provides more texture and emotional depth. Many artists also incorporate illustration into the blacked-out space, turning the page into a visual composition.



Works like Zong! demonstrate how blackout poetry can engage directly with history and politics. By erasing and reshaping archival documents, poets can critique power structures, highlight marginalized voices, and reframe historical narratives. This form is often more abstract but deeply impactful.

Digital Blackout Poetry

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With the rise of digital tools, blackout poetry has expanded beyond paper. Creators use apps, PDFs, and design software to redact text and share their work online. This format makes it easier to experiment, edit, and distribute poems across social platforms, helping the form reach a wider audience.

As you can see, blackout poetry can take many surprising new shapes. Contemplate which form of blackout poetry works for you and get to creating! Maybe you'll even discover a brand new form.

RELATED POSTS

- [Different Types of Poems and Poem Structures →](#)
- [What is a Poem — Exploring the Art of Words →](#)
- [What is Imagery — Definition & Examples in Literature & Poetry →](#)



From newspaper articles and magazines to the dusty one dollar book pile at the thrift store, part of the appeal of blackout poetry art is its accessibility. With just an old book (or screenplay!) and a marker, you too can be a blackout poet.

1. **Source:** Your source can be anything with preexisting text. The most common sources are newspapers, books, and magazines, but if the back of a cereal box is what you feel called to, go for it!
2. **Inspiration:** Scanning the source material, you'll want to choose a block of text to pull from. For our example, we'll use the front page of a newspaper. Use a pencil to underline the words that catch your eye, regardless of if they feel connected. 0
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3. **Create:** After marking the potential words, you'll want to read over them to see what story is emerging. Here you can add or remove words for flow and find connecting words if needed. 0
4. **Commit:** Once you finalize your word selection, highlight the words more boldly drawing a box, circle, or underline with a pen to make sure they stand out. 0
5. **Blackout:** Cover all unwanted text so that only your circled words remain. Stay true to the name "black out poem," our example below uses a black permanent marker, but you can cover the redacted words with anything you'd like. 0
6. **Share your work:** Whether you're a first time or long time poet, hashtags like #blackoutpoetry and #newspaperpoems are filled with erasure poems. 0

Once you've completed your first blackout poem, don't stop there. Like any creative practice, blackout poetry becomes more rewarding the more you experiment. So turn that poetry month into a poetry year and try working with different types of source material. This can include dense novels, poetic prose, news articles, or even scripts.

Another helpful approach is to create multiple versions from the same page. By selecting different words or arranging them in new ways, you'll start to see how many possible poems are hidden within a single block of text. This not only sharpens your eye for language but also helps you think more flexibly about structure and meaning.

there. After all, that's what making art is all about, right?

RELATED POSTS

- [What is a Sonnet? →](#)
- [What is Iambic Pentameter? →](#)
- [Different Types of Poems and Poem Structures →](#)

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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Common questions about blackout poetry

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What is blackout poetry?

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How to make a blackout poem?

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Who invented blackout poetry?

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What are the rules for blackout poetry?

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What is the most famous blackout poem?

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UP NEXT

Cure your writer's block

Writer's block often happens because the blank page feels intimidating. Black out poetry removes the pressure to start from nothing and forces the brain into a creative space. Too often we meet the page while with the stress of writing something that can be produced on a specific budget, but with poetry one can write for play. If you're looking for other ways to reignite your creativity, check out our list of 23 ways to overcome writer's block. We promise it'll be just as fascinating as exploring blackout poetry art.

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Up Next: Curing writer's block

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[Shamikah Martinez](#)

Screenwriter, poet, and performer exploring how emotion becomes language on the page, stage, screen, and in community. She has written for Apple TV+ and Nickelodeon, developed original pilots for FOX and Paramount+, and founded Poetic Film Club, a youth program that bridges poetry, film, and feeling.

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